

MEASURED ON 5,000 GOVERNMENT PAGES

What actually lifts a government post on social media?

We compared every page with itself, July to September. The winners are about people. Two popular tips do nothing.

Six things we measured →

THE RANKING

Engagement vs. the same page's usual post

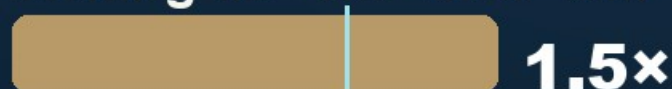
Congratulating a person



Saying thank you



Writing as "we" and "our"



Using emoji



Using hashtags



Ending with a question



a page's usual post = 1x

369,000 local-government Facebook posts, Jul 1 to Sep 23, 2026.
Each page compared with its own other posts (median).

NO. 1

Congratulate someone.

Retirements, promotions, years of service, a new hire. Posts that congratulate a person draw 3.6× the page's usual engagement, and three times the comments.

Higher than the page's usual post on 88% of the 634 pages that post them.

NO. 2

Say thank you.

Posts that thank someone draw 1.9× the page's usual engagement. Only about 1 in 10 government posts says it.

Higher on 78% of 2,562 pages.

WHAT DOESN'T MOVE IT

Hashtags and emoji.

Hashtags: 1.0×, no change. Emoji: 1.1×, barely.
And ending a post with a question does slightly worse than the page's usual post.

More on questions this Thursday.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Put people first.

The posts that beat a page's own average are about people: who did the work, who deserves credit, who is being thanked.

See how your community's posts compare with peers, free:

govfeeds.com/free-report

GovFeeds